



Challenge Framing Canva

Turn a contested issue into one decision the room can defend – and know exactly when to reopen it.

DECISION COUNCIL

Write short facts. Separate evidence from assumptions. Do not choose until the backup and switch condition are visible.

1

Frame the decision and value before discussing solutions

One question and one business result the room can test

What must be decided?

Write a clear choice: Should we choose... or... to achieve a defined result?

Target business value

Growth or revenue

Cost

Cycle time

Risk

Capacity or quality

Baseline now

Direction or target – by when?

Why now? What is the cost of delay?

What will stall, worsen or compound if the decision is delayed?

2

Reveal current reality

Before change

Who is affected?

Affected groups and roles.

How is it handled today?

The real path, not the documented procedure.

What workaround is in use today?

How do people reach the result now – and where do they pay the cost?

What works and must be preserved?

A bright spot or successful exception the new decision must not destroy.

3

Open the alternatives

Two to four options, including continuing as is

OPTION A

Option name

What changes?

Biggest constraint

OPTION B

Option name

What changes?

Biggest constraint

OPTION C

Option name

What changes?

Biggest constraint

REFERENCE OPTION

Continue as is

What happens if nothing changes now?

Temporary benefit

Expected cost

4

Stress-test the choice

Before naming a winner

The lens that moves us forward

The lens that prevents recklessness

Decision criterion	A	B	C	As is
1.				
2.				
3.				
4.				

What we know - Evidence

A source we can retrieve

What we assume

Needs a test or verification

What we do not know

A gap that could change the decision

5

Record the decision

A decision is a choice, authority and review condition - not general agreement

First choice and why it was selected

Write the option, then the decisive reason it beat the alternatives.

Backup option

When do we switch?

Write an observable condition, not a general feeling.

Where are we confident - and where is evidence still needed?

Decision framing

StrongNeeds evidence

Selection criteria

StrongNeeds evidence

Available evidence

StrongNeeds evidence

Decision authority

ClearUnclear

Make the decision hold in work

From approval to first live evidence

01

Decider

Who can say yes or no?

02

Result owner

A named human, not a committee.

03

First evidence of value in work

What change appears in the measure or behaviour?

04

Review date

A fixed date and accountable forum.

05

Reversal or escalation condition

What brings the decision back to the room?

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Decision or question in play

Unfilled space

Missing control or evidence